

NOTE

There are a lot of options Qemu can provide you. It can allow you to use multiple hard disk files at once, emulate USB drives, network interfaces and a whole lot more. We won't tell you about all of them. You can learn about the various options provided by issuing the command:

```
qemu-kvm -help
```

Also, note that there's a command line option which Qemu provides you with to go full screen on your Qemu virtual machine: `-full-screen` option. Make sure you use it only when you know that all other parameters passed are correct and you're not going to get stuck at some point while the guest operating system is still running. This is because Qemu won't allow you to leave the fullscreen easily. We couldn't find a way except killing the X-Server.

Also remember that Qemu requires the `kqemu` kernel module. Without that Qemu is only a processor emulator, not a virtualization package. Installing Qemu would usually install the kernel module as well but we mention it separately because at times, the kernel module may not be added and you would need to "modprobe" it.

Additionally, you can use the command "qemu" rather than "qemu-kvm" and provide it with an option to utilize the KVM module but the performance and stability of `qemu-kvm` is way better because it's a separate project created for the dedicated support of KVM into Qemu.

command line to create `qcow2` format images with Qemu and then create backed images, there's no way to get snapshots. No 3D support. Support for audio isn't that great either. Yeah, bummer. Processing performance is the only benefit here with Qemu/KVM.

Apart from this, if you've got only Qemu and KVM isn't present, even processing improvements will go downhill, all the way. The reason is Qemu, in itself is not too great a virtualization software because that was not the main use of it. Qemu, as a matter of fact, was created to emulate various processors. So you could emulate a 64-bit computer on a 32-bit one. You could emulate SPARC (various versions), ARM and even PowerPC architectures on an Intel machine. Yes, that was the actual use of Qemu. It slowly developed into a virtualization software but processor architecture emulation is still its area of expertise, and it stands tall in the OSS arena. For a decent enough performance from Qemu, you're going to require KVM.